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Document Code: SOP-15	ACTIONS TO ADDRESS RISKS AND OPPORTUNITIES		

Introduction

This procedure describes the process followed for addressing risks and opportunities, according to the requirements of sub clause 8.5 of the PNS ISO/IEC 17025:2017 standard.

1. Responsibilities & Authorities

1. Regional Director
2. Laboratory Manager
3. Quality Assurance Manager
4. Technical Manager
5. Staff

2. Risks and Opportunities Identification

2.1. The laboratory considers the risks and opportunities associated the laboratory activities through:

- a. Identification of internal strengths and weakness and external opportunities and threats, which are recorded in LF 15-03, SWOT Analysis Register;
- b. Internal issues comprises of the five resources (Man, Machine, Method, Material, Money) and the limitations;
- c. External issues are prospects and restrictions related to political, economic, social, technological, legal and environmental (PESTLE) issues.

2.2. Sources of risks to impartiality are identified. Risks to impartiality can be:

- a. Laboratory activities;
- b. Commercial, financial or others that may affect the integrity of laboratory results;
- c. Laboratory relationships.

2.3. Opportunities are also identified such as:

- a. Expand the scope of laboratory activities;
- b. Technological advances;
- c. Address customer needs;
- d. Attract potential customers.

Prepared by: MA. MAURICE A. BANQUILING Quality Assurance Manager	Reviewed and Approved by: EUGENE GAY B. JAMORA Laboratory Manager
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3. Identification of Risks and Opportunities using Process Approach

3.1. Risks and opportunities are identified through the process approach and recorded in LF 15-02, Process Approach Register. The form is filled up through listing the:

- Input of the process;
- Requirements to meet the output;
- Process and person responsible;
- Output;
- Risk and Opportunities found in the process.

3.2. Identification of risk and opportunities through the process approach is done on twice a year.

4. Risk Analysis and Risk Evaluation

4.1. Risk analysis and risk evaluation is done through the risks and opportunities register and recorded in the form LF 15-01, Risks and Opportunities Register.

4.2. Events are identified. It can be programs, projects and activities. It is categorized as a risk or opportunity.

4.3. The severity and probability of the event is determined. Severity can be low, medium or high. Probability is listed as never happens, can happen yearly and can happen daily/weekly/monthly. The severity is multiplied to the probability ($S \times P$).

4.3.1. The table below shows the interpretation of severity multiplied to probability ($S \times P$):

	Probability		
Severity	1	2	3
	2	4	6
	3	6	9

Legend:

Green – Low (no actions needed)

Prepared by: MA. MAURICE A. BANQUILING Quality Assurance Manager	Reviewed and Approved by: EUGENE GAY B. JAMORA Laboratory Manager
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Blue – Medium (no actions needed)

Red –High (address risk or opportunity)

4.4. Actions, persons responsible, resources needed and target date are identified.

4.5. The effectiveness of the risk and opportunities register is also identified after implementation of action.

5. Risk Treatment

5.1. Options to address risks and opportunities can include:

- a. Avoiding risk;
- b. Taking risk in order to pursue an opportunity;
- c. Eliminating the risk source;
- d. Changing the likelihood or consequences;
- e. Sharing the risk;
- f. Retaining risk by informed decision;
- g. SWOT analysis;
- h. Formal business risk assessment through meeting minutes, SWOT analysis, planning, analysis and evaluation activities, and risk determination or evaluation records.

6. Risk Monitoring and Review

6.1. Evaluation of effectiveness of treatment of risk and opportunities is done in a monthly basis.

7. Documents and Forms

LF 15-01, Risks and Opportunities Register

LF 15-02, Process Approach Register

LF 15-03, SWOT Analysis Register

Prepared by: MA. MAURICE A. BANQUILING Quality Assurance Manager	Reviewed and Approved by: EUGENE GAY B. JAMORA Laboratory Manager
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Republic of the Philippines
Department of Agriculture
BUREAU OF FISHERIES AND AQUATIC RESOURCES
REGIONAL FISHERIES LABORATORY XII
J. Catolico St., Lagao, General Santos City

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8. Document History

Revision No.	Issue Date	Original Entry	Revised as	Recall Date

Prepared by:

MA. MAURICE A. BANQUILING
Quality Assurance Manager

Reviewed and Approved by:

EUGENE GAY B. JAMORA
Laboratory Manager